From Zero to Mesh

Secure, Resilient Traffic Between Your Services with Kong Mesh

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How much do you use a mesh today?

A Not using one

B Evaluating

C In production on Kubernetes

D In production on VMs

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Three jobs

1

Retry

2

Identity

3

Failover

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Why a mesh

1

Sidecar

Beside each app

2

Control plane

Sends the rules

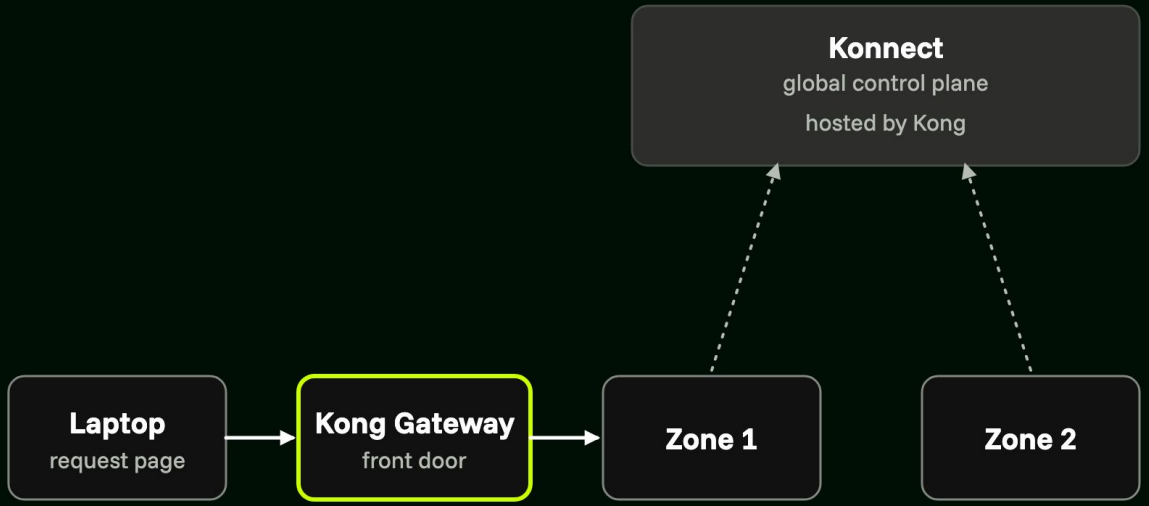
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What you will see

1. Two Kubernetes zones
2. Gateway: the front door
3. Konnect: control plane
4. A live request page

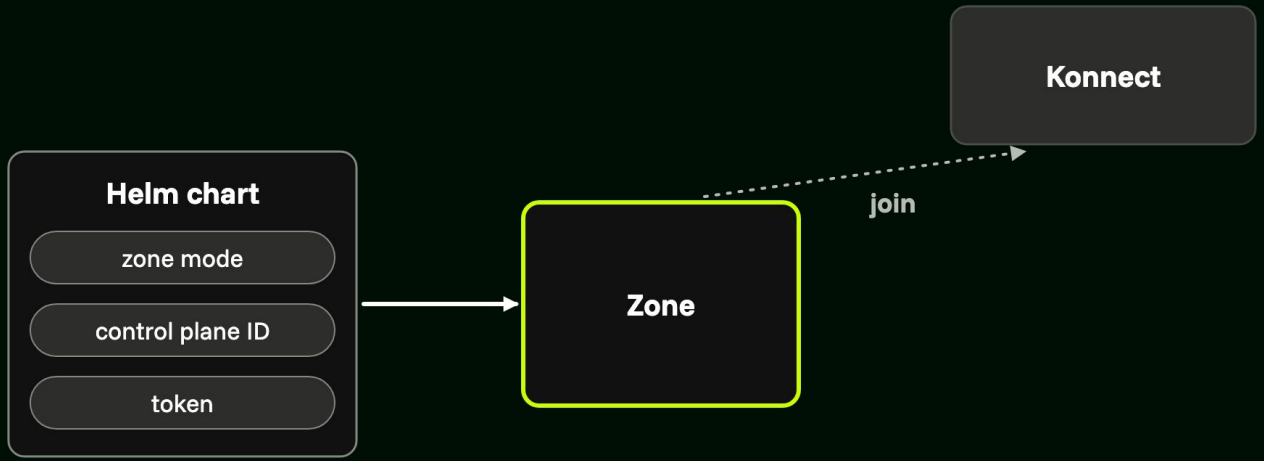
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How it fits



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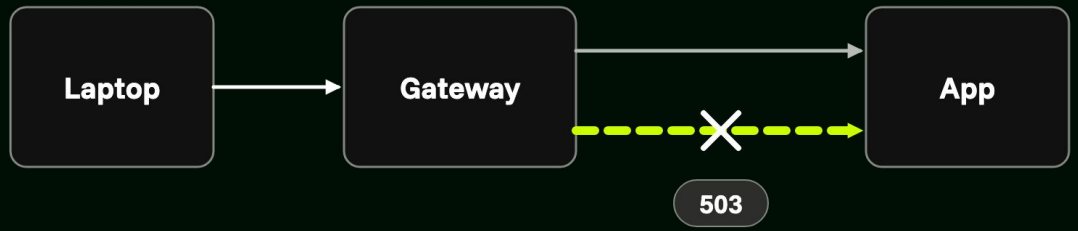
Install and join



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Baseline

95 of 200 failed



no policy

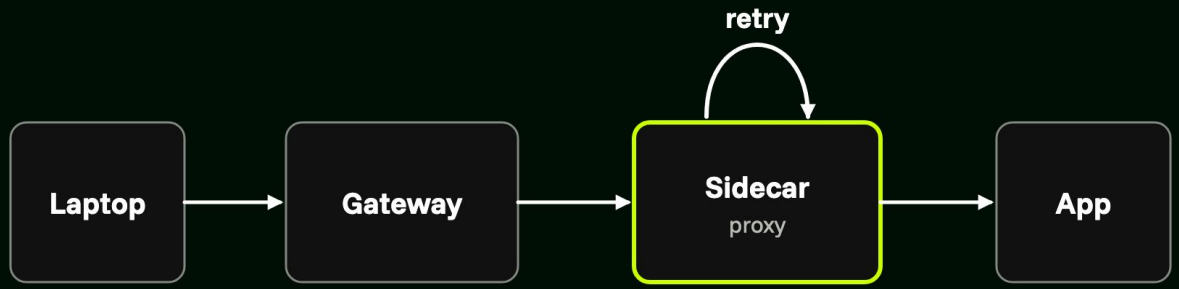
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Can one policy hide a failure?

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Retry

up to 3 tries on a 503



13 of 200

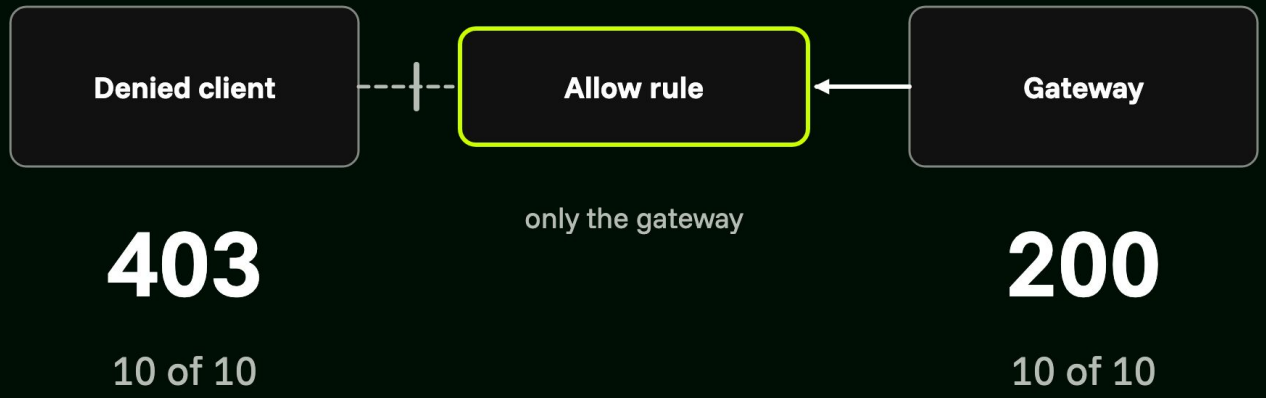
failed

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Who may call whom?

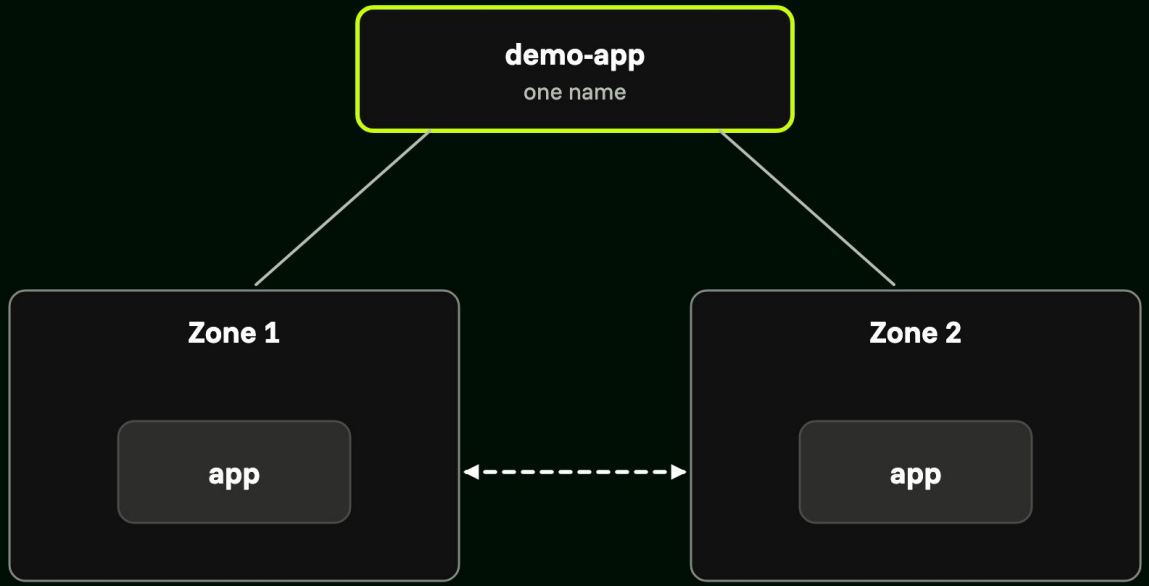
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Identity



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One service, two zones

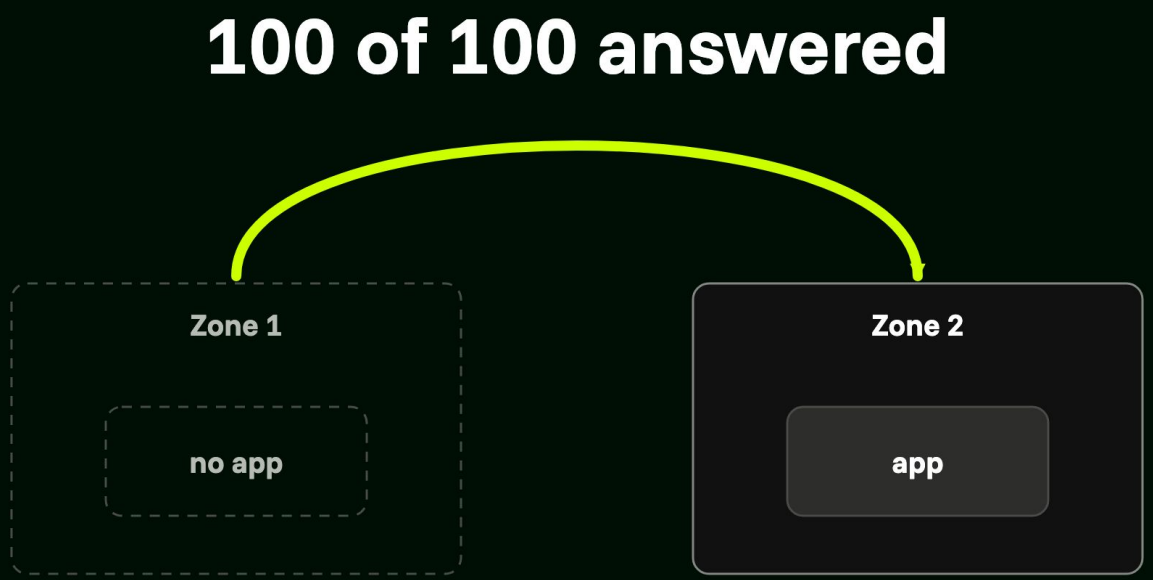


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What if zone 1 loses its app?

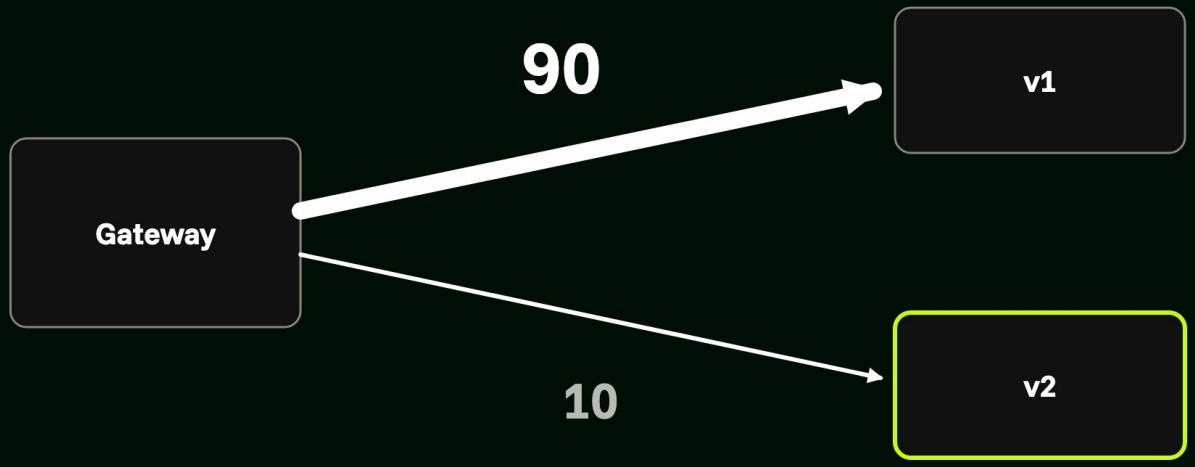
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Failover



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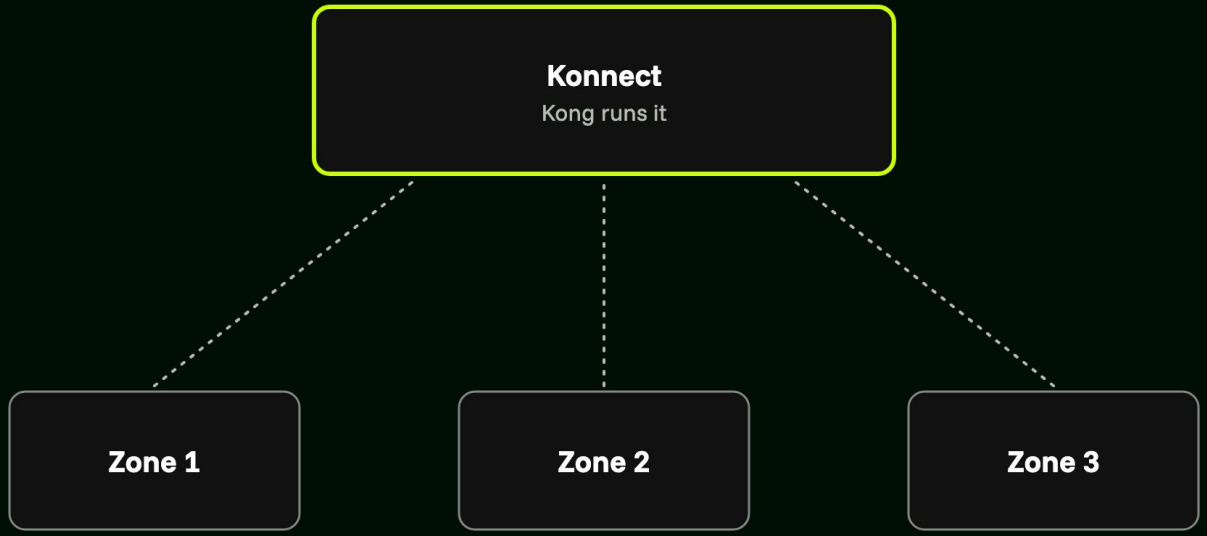
Canary (stretch)



no app change

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What you do not run



you run none

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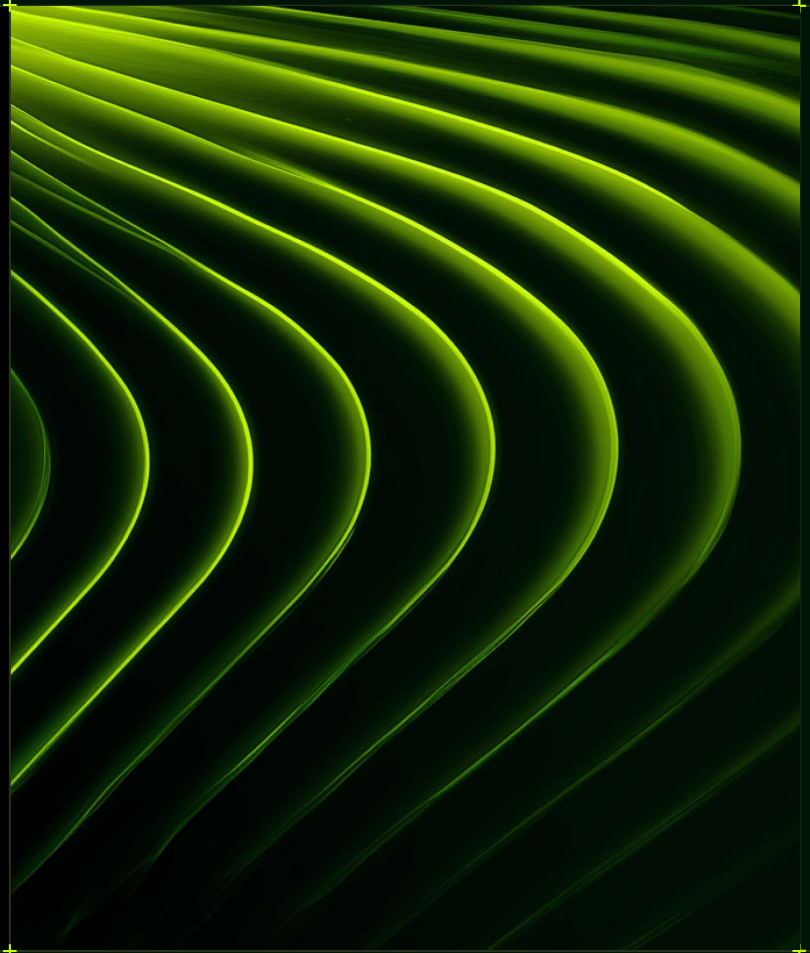
Key takeaways

1. Retry hides failures
2. Identity limits callers
3. Failover moves traffic

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Go deeper

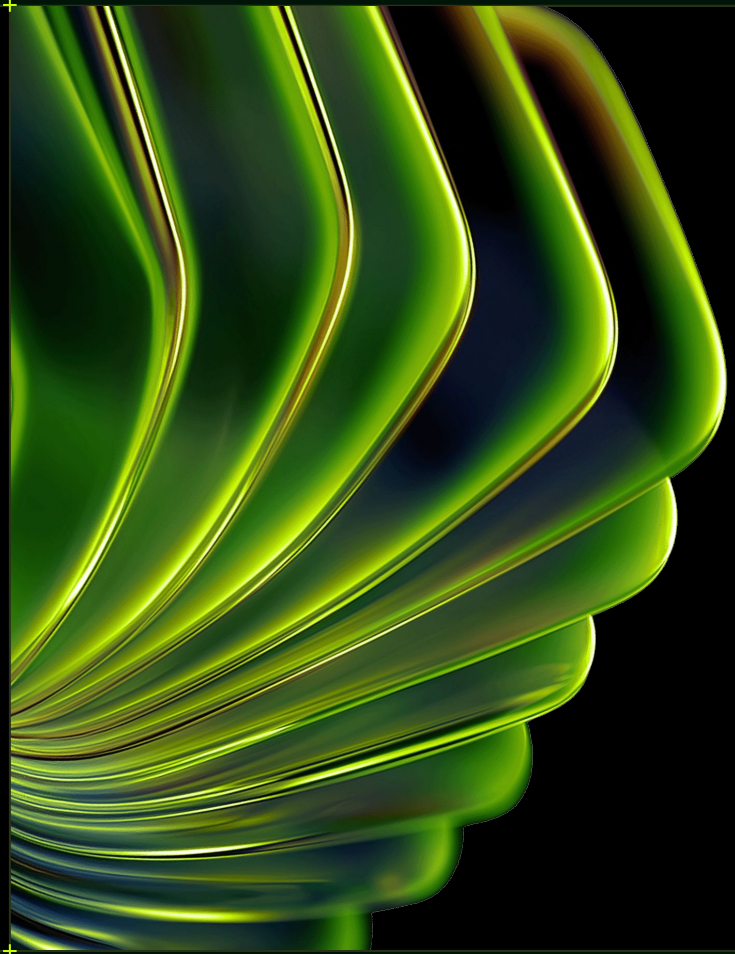
- Zone proxies
- Locality-aware load balancing
- MeshExternalService



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Resources and download

- Everything shown is in the download
- Link: https://konghq-cx.github.io/cs-webinars/webinars/2026-10-from-zero-to-mesh/
- Configs and demo scripts



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Thank you



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